



Faraday Future is real

Faraday Future's production car will be unveiled at CES 2017, this January.
<http://dgit.in/FarFtre>



Best phone camera

Google Pixel's camera makes it 2016's best camera yet. Surprised?
<http://dgit.in/BestCamSft>



PARAMETER #2: BOKEH EFFECT

Apple iPhone 7 Plus

Apple's camera engineers are big fans of soft, blurred backgrounds with the subject crisply in focus in the foreground. Hence, the move from an f/2.2 lens in the iPhone 6s to the f/1.8 lens here. However, the software mode that Apple had announced to enhance bokeh has not hit the iPhones yet. Nevertheless, what you get here is the intrinsic physical property of the lens and its ability to create soft, blurred backgrounds, and on an overall note, it does succeed.



The iPhone 7 Plus creates finely blurred backgrounds when you are shooting close to your subject at wide angle. This creates a discernible difference between the foreground and the background, making compositions look more appealing. Even shadows retain a fine bit of detail, which contributes into giving a finer blur of the background. However, while the difference in background blur is evident when you compare it with other smartphone cameras, it is not the finest at bokeh.

The soon-to-arrive update for the iPhone 7 Plus' software optimisation to deliver better bokeh will hopefully be worth the wait, because shallow depth of field in photographs is better in the other two smartphones here.

Huawei P9

The Huawei P9 relies mostly on its software to produce blurred backgrounds, so if you are shooting in default auto, this will not create any shots worthy of being compared to your DSLR's 50mm f/1.4 lens. The Huawei P9 uses f/2.2 lenses, which is what most smartphones of the previous generation have used. To create bokeh, the P9 uses the second camera to capture the background, and the first camera captures the foreground. Once the photograph is shot, you can



choose to select your area of focus, hence creating an effect similar to the shallow depth of field that wide aperture lenses will produce.

The results, however, are evidently software-optimised, something that even you can achieve on your smartphone with Google's Snapseed photo editor. Huawei's big bet is on low light performance, image sharpness and details, and the bokeh optimisation is an incidental by-product of the dual-camera setup.

It is not the greatest at producing blurred backgrounds, and if you own the Huawei P9, you will be required to be happy with the blurred backgrounds processed by the Huawei P9's image signal processor (ISP).

Honor 8

The Honor 8, meanwhile, puts clear emphasis on bokeh. It, too, uses a similar lens setup, but by default, whenever you switch the camera app on, the Honor 8 switches on the bokeh optimisation, too. Yet again, photographs look more synthetically processed than out of the lens' property, although for most, it does suffice. The Honor 8 also allows post-shooting refocus, to choose your area of focus.

The results are somewhat similar to the Huawei P9, although other aspects



of the smartphone's camera affects image backgrounds. Here, the level of crisp details and sharpness is lesser, which leads to softer, finer bokeh. Many would find the bokeh produced by the Honor 8 to be quite impressive, even though it is mostly software-induced.

The bokeh produced by the Honor 8 is also affected by the image noise produced by the camera's sensors, more on that in our next section. It is also important to note that despite putting much emphasis on bokeh, the Honor 8 still favours using an f/2.2 lens for shooting photographs. Other compatriots such as the Samsung Galaxy S7 Edge and the iPhone 7 Plus have moved on to wider aperture lenses, although these phones are considerably more expensive.